BRIDGING FUND

ISSUED 04/03/2026

PURPOSE: The Club has developed this policy to **ensure that every child has the opportunity to participate in basketball with Phoenix**, regardless of their family's financial situation.

It exists to support families experiencing financial hardship so that no young athlete is prevented from joining or continuing in the Club's programs due to financial barriers.

REVISION: All Club policies, procedures guides and checklists are reviewed every January following the appointment of the new committee in November of each year.

They may also be reviewed before each season or too meet compliance requirements.

POLICY STATEMENT: The Club is committed to fostering an **inclusive and welcoming environment** where all young athletes can develop skills, build confidence, and be part of the Phoenix family.

The Bridging Fund reflects this commitment by providing financial assistance for essential costs related to participation — such as registration fees, uniforms, and necessary equipment — to eligible families.

Donations to the Bridging Fund are encouraged to help sustain this support.

WHAT IS A BRIDGING FUND?

The Bridging Fund assists families experiencing financial hardship.

WHAT DOES THE BRIDGING FUND PAY FOR?

The Bridging Fund may be used to pay for registration fees, uniforms and essentials such as a basketball.

SCOPE: This policy applies to all junior players, parents/guardians, coaches, team managers, and volunteers involved in the Club.

It covers situations where support is needed for essential costs such as registration fees, uniforms, and equipment, particularly where other avenues of financial assistance—like government programs or vouchers—have already been accessed.

Applications are assessed confidentially by the Club Treasurer, outcomes are recorded at the next Committee meeting, and approved support is provided to ensure full participation in Club programs.

ELIGIBILITY

The player must meet the following criteria:

- Be aged between 5 and 17 years old.
- Be registering with the Club.
- Have exhausted any applicable government funding such as Get Active Kids Voucher Program.
- Be listed on a valid Services Australia concession card (if applicable).

WHY DOES PHOENIX HAVE A BRIDGING FUND?

The Club is committed to ensuring that every child has the opportunity to participate in basketball, regardless of financial circumstances.

The Bridging Fund serves to support families experiencing financial difficulties, ensuring that no player is

PHOENIX UNITED BASKETBALL DEVELOPMENT CLUB INC
HELLO@BENDIGOPHOENIX.ORG.AU WWW.BENDIGOPHOENIX.ORG.AU

BRIDGING FUND

ISSUED 04/03/2026

HOW DO I APPLY?

Email the Treasurer at treasurer@bendigophoenix.org.au for a confidential discussion about your circumstances. An application via email is required for each season.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT?

After reviewing your circumstances, the Treasurer will forward your application to the Club office bearers. They will review your application and make a decision. The Treasurer will notify you of the outcome via email. At the next scheduled Club committee meeting your application will be noted with the outcome. Any confidential information will not be circulated.

excluded from the Club's programs due to hardship.

This policy reflects the Club's dedication to fostering an inclusive environment where all young athletes can develop their skills, build confidence, and be part of the Phoenix family.

The aim is to make basketball accessible to all, regardless of financial situation.

FUNDS DISTRIBUTION

Successful applicants will receive a voucher code to be applied at checkout when paying fees in PlayHQ.

Any other approved funds will be managed by the Treasurer for the purchase of approved items.

SUPPORTING THE BRIDGING FUND

If you can afford it, consider contributing to ensure all children have the opportunity to play basketball and be part of the Phoenix family.

To donate email the Treasurer at treasurer@bendigophoenix.org.au to find out how.

RELATED POLICIES:

- Fee Policy
- Registration & Grading Policy
- Refunds Policy
- Uniform Policy

PHOENIX UNITED BASKETBALL DEVELOPMENT CLUB INC
HELLO@BENDIGOPHOENIX.ORG.AU WWW.BENDIGOPHOENIX.ORG.AU